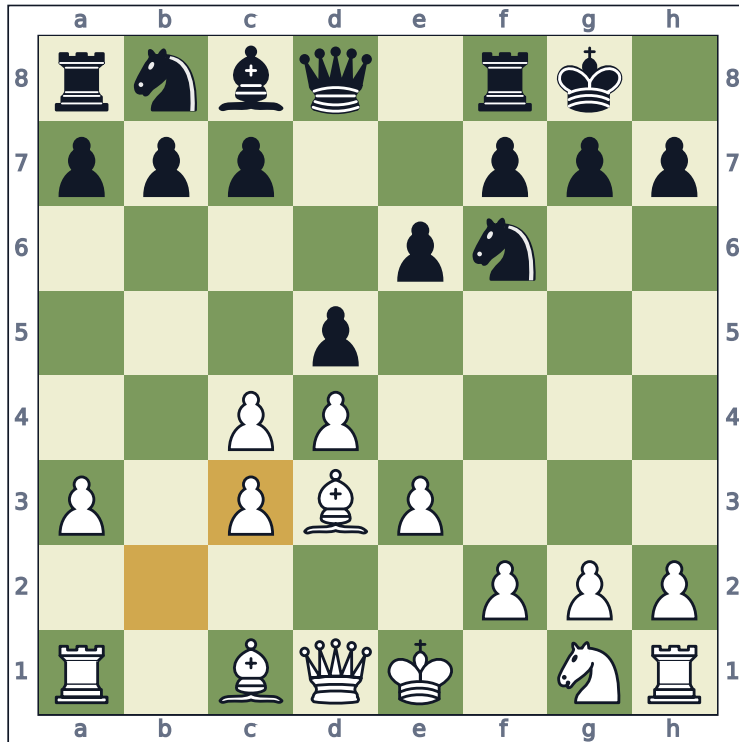


## NIMZO-INDIAN DEFENSE

# Nimzo-Indian Defense

ECO E49 | 1 named line in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

## IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

## ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.26 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

## GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

## WHAT THIS OPENING IS

E49 covers Nimzo-Indian Defense. Black pins the c3 knight and fights for e4, often exchanging a bishop for structural control or rapid development. The diagram uses the featured line Nimzo-Indian Defense: Normal Variation, Botvinnik System.

## DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e3 O-O 5. Bd3 d5 6. a3 Bxc3+ 7. bxc3

## UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

# What both sides are trying to achieve

**WHITE'S GOALS**

Use the bishop pair and central space, manage doubled pawns constructively, and decide whether e4 or a queenside advance is realistic.

**BLACK'S GOALS**

Pressure c4/e4, exploit weak squares, and choose the right moment to surrender or preserve the dark-squared bishop.

**PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING**

Black uses ...c5, ...d5, or ...e5; White often seeks e4, d5, or queenside expansion with a3 and b4.

**PIECE MAP**

The c3 knight, e4 square, and bishop-pair decision are the strategic core. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

**WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG**

Doubled pawns are not automatically weak: activity, open files, and central control may compensate fully. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

**POSITION SNAPSHOT**

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c3, White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e3, Black pawn on e6.

**WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?**

One of Black's very best defenses to 1.d4, rich enough for a lifetime of study.

## COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

# Every named E49 line

This section preserves all 1 names and defining routes assigned to E49 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

**001**    **Nimzo-Indian Defense: Normal Variation, Botvinnik System**  
1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e3 O-O 5. Bd3 d5 6. a3 Bxc3+ 7. bxc3